

Chili en Crôte

5 lb. (2.5kg) ground beef
1 Tbs. salt
3 Tbs. sugar
¼ cup (60ml) olive oil
5 Tbs. all-purpose flour
1 yellow onion, chopped
5 garlic cloves, minced
½ cup Urban Accents Rio Grande
Chili Powder*

Freshly ground pepper, to taste
2 tsp. dried oregano
1 can (28 oz./875g) chopped tomatoes
with juices
3 cups (750ml) chicken stock*
¼ cup (40g) cornmeal
1 package Buckeye Corn Bread Mix*

In a large sauté pan over medium-high heat, combine the ground beef, salt and sugar and cook, stirring, until browned, about 10 minutes. Drain the meat and transfer to a slow cooker.

In the same pan over medium heat, warm the olive oil. Add the flour and cook, stirring,

2 to 3 minutes; do not allow it to brown. Add the onion and sauté for 5 minutes. Add the garlic, chili powder, pepper and oregano and heat, stirring occasionally, until fragrant, 3 to 4 minutes. Add the tomatoes with their juices and cook for 7 to 10 minutes, then pour the mixture into the slow cooker. Add the stock and cornmeal. Cover and cook for 6 hours on high or 8 hours on low. After the chili is cooked, skim off any fat from the surface.

Preheat an oven to 375°F (190°C).

Prepare the corn bread batter according to the package instructions. Divide the chili evenly among 8 ovenproof bowls. Top each with a scant ½ cup (125ml) of the batter. Using a small offset spatula, spread the batter over the center two-thirds of the chili, being careful not to mix the batter with the chili. Place the bowls on a baking sheet and bake until a toothpick inserted into the center of the corn bread comes out clean, 25 to 30 minutes. Serve immediately. Serves 8.

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* Available at Williams-Sonoma stores.

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